AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

MAY 2011

English Compulsory Paper II

Time allowed: 2 hours 15 minutes Marks 50

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign that it is correct.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL THREE questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use ONLY black ink.
   Do not use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   DO NOT write outside the answer box.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 18 Marks)

Read the passage and answer all the questions that follow:

Not everyone knows but this year, 2010 was designated as 'The International Year of Biodiversity' by the United Nations which currently estimates that at least three species of plants, animals, birds, fish, insects are becoming extinct every single hour of every single day! This means something like 72 species a day, some of which have not even been identified as yet. These species are disappearing from the planet every 24 hours which is both astonishing and an extremely disturbing figure.

This is the fastest rate of species extinction since the dinosaurs and their natural world disappeared so many millions of years ago. While dinosaurs are thought to have become victims of the climate change at that time, today's extinctions are being blamed on a combination of things including loss of habitat, reduction in forest cover, expansion of cities, industrial pollution, over fishing and on changing climatic conditions too.

Back in 2002, the UN launched an ambitious plan to slow down the rate of species extinction by 2010, but the plan failed miserably. This time around, they are trying to involve commercial enterprises, particularly big businesses by pointing out to them how much potential profit there is in maintaining the biodiversity of the natural world.

For example, numerous pharmaceutical companies rely on wild plant materials for their research. However, if the same companies, who currently have to pay large amounts of money to obtain the required plant material, set up their own plant production areas, maintaining them in a natural way, they would both save money and create employment while generating a responsible attitude towards nature in the people working for them.

Furthermore, the tourist industry would reap considerable profits if beaches, coral reefs, the sea and natural sea and shore life were properly maintained, while switching to organic methods of farming can render crops more profitable than they would otherwise be. Obviously, some people consider the commercialization of the natural world to be an absolute non-starter but, if such projects can be launched in a viable manner, then they may just lead to a noticeable slow down in the loss of biodiversity which is happening right now.

Source: www.voanews.com

a. What is the aim of United Nations in designating 2010 as the international year of biodiversity? Explain in THREE points. (3 Marks)

b. Do you agree with the idea that commercialising nature in order to protect biodiversity can be successful? Give at least TWO reasons. (5 Marks)

c. What are the causes of extinction of various species of animals and plants? Elaborate in three points. (4 Marks)

d. Write a summary of the last 3 paragraphs of the given passage. The summary should be around 50 words. (6 Marks)

Q.2. (Total 14 Marks)

Compose a response of about 120 words on any ONE of the options a or b.

EITHER

a. Youth of today are more critical, rather than being appreciative of their country. You have read a letter recently written by a youngster to a newspaper editor, mentioning the difficulties faced by him in his country. Being a responsible citizen, reply to that letter, outlining the responsibilities of youth for the development of a country.

OR

b. You have recently been chosen as a Student Council's president by the students of your school. Write a letter to your friend telling him/her about the publicity campaign, attributes that the candidates must possess in order to win the election and the duties one needs to carry out.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 6 and 7.

Option _____

Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200 words on any ONE of the options a, b or c.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Many students complain that they are forced to opt for a career of their parents' choice. Do you think children should have more liberty in choosing their profession? Give reasons and specific examples to support your ideas.

OR

b. The modern electronic machines and gadgets have been a blessing in one's life style. Do you agree or disagree with this statement? Give reasons to support your argument.

OR

c. If you could have a super power, what would it be? Explain what that super power is and why you have chosen it?

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 9 and 10.

Option _____

PLEASE TURN OVER THE PAGE

END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

Please use this page for rough work